

or the healthiest option, agriculture takes centre stage once again for all of us. The obvious expectation is an increased reliance on GMO crops as the weather plays spoilsport, and we seek to make ever smaller land areas produce ever more crops.

Automation will obviously play a large role in making food production a more efficient process, as will pesticides and soil additives. Crop management and better weather forecasting which will also help.

moisture, etc, to encourage much higher yields, as everything is done indoors. By far the biggest advantage is the reduction in travel time and costs, which makes sure that residents of large cities get fresh vegetables.

Of course such farms would need help in the form of government subsidies on land, or need visionary investors to set them up. We think the ever crowding metro cities around the world will get their acts together and encourage urban farming.

know how to use it as well. As computing power has steadily increased over the years, the ability to number crunch goes up, which means more meaningful insights can be gleaned from data.

Let's take the example of a simple tyre pressure and temperature monitoring system, which connects to your car's central console and displays the status of your tyres. A gimmick, right? Because none of us really need that level of information for personal cars. However, when a trucking company or a transport company wants to monitor their tyres, they're doing it because it can save them time and money.

Continental, a global tyre manufacturer and consultant to large transport companies connected a tyre monitoring device to a Vodafone SIM card to set up a monitoring system that allows a central office to keep a tab of the tyre pressure and temperature for hundreds or even thousands of vehicles. The central office could monitor trucks and buses every time they pulled into a scheduled stop, or when it came back to the depot.

Although we all know that having the right tyre pressure extends the life of the tyres, and also helps conserve fuel, we don't bother because the savings are small and spread out over years. In a large company, however, those savings accumulate pretty quickly, and soon millions are being saved. That's just one implementation of the IoT that will become completely mainstream in the next few years. There are literally unlimited ways in which the IoT can benefit companies, and even us as individuals.

What's really going to rise, sadly, over the next decade are attacks on IoT devices, and already the security market for IoT devices is skyrocketing. From medical devices such as pacemakers to monitoring devices such as Fitbits, everything is vulnerable to attack the minute it's connected to the internet. However, vulnerabilities are just part and parcel of accepting technology into our lives, and there's no such thing as a safe place online, and this is something we already know. Hopefully the next decade will succeed in bringing in the more secure devices.

Man's home locks him out for being too dumb

Finally fed up of not being listened to, a Florida man's autonomous home has kicked him out for good. In the report that the home filed with the department of robotics, the AI claimed that the man refused to clean the house, always left dirty dishes lying out of reach of the AI, had skipped three mandatory services of the equipment already, and refused to update the AI software for over a year.

Police arrested the man under destruction of property laws after he was found trying to break into his own house by ripping the door of the hinges. He will spend at least 3 months in confinement for disturbing the peace, and there is no news on what will happen to the AI itself.

However, the biggest change we expect to see in the next decade across the world is an increase in urban farming. We're not talking about people's little vegetable patches in their backyards, we mean proper vertical farms and greenhouses that will grow a lot of high yield food really quickly. The biggest advantage of vertical farms is that they're the equivalent of a data center whereas regular farms are more like your home network. They're precision controlled, weather independent, can run on clean energy and use far less surface area. While a regular farmer needs acres of space to be able to yield a certain amount of crops, urban farms can yield the same amount from a much smaller footprint. Of course they will also use a surface area of acres of soil, but they will do so in a building that is several levels high.

Then there's the ability to precision control the air (make it carbon dioxide rich) and control the temperature,

IOT

Yes, we know, the Internet of Things is so 2014 when it comes to buzzwords, but that's because buzzwords usually predate the actual adoption of technologies. If buzzwords are the earthquakes then what we expect to see in the coming decade is the Tsunami that follows after.

And no we're not talking about your router and tablet PCs in your homes, we're talking about a true Internet of Things, which includes what we used to call sensor webs back in 2004. We love our data now, and we



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